[EDD]

EDD is calculated from first day of the Last Menstural Period [LMP] by using Naegle's formula. For calculation, 9 calendar months and 7 days are added in the LMP

Gestational age – It is to be calculated as completed weeks of gestation



- 9 out of 10 women experience a change in skin tone during pregnancy called hyperpigmentation. This is because the increased production of melanin during pregnancy.
- During gestation, babies develop hair all over their body called "lanugo". This hair is typically shed before birth.
- Uterus stretches from the size of a pear to approximately the size of watermelon over the course of pregnancy.
- Morning sickness is very common and typically goes away by the second trimester. Try to eat bland diet like bananas, rice, and toast to settle your stomach. Avoid spicy, oily and fried foods during night.

Antenatal Care

Antenatal care refers to the care given to an expectant mother from the time of conception to the beginning of labour. It includes,

- Maternal health check ups.
- Evaluation of fetal health and development
- Detection of high risk pregnancies e.g GDM, PIH
- Prompt intervention to prevent complications.
- Health education. e.g Diet, exercise and follow up

Aims

- To achieve a healthy mother and baby.
- To provide psychological support to the women and her family.
- To educate the women regarding health care during pregnancy.
- To monitor progress of pregnancy and the baby.
- To recognize deviation from the normal and provide treatment as required.
- To prepare women physically and emotionally for the child birth, lactation and care of the baby.
- To prevent congenital deformities by educating the mother to avoid smoking, substance abuse and self medications.

Antenatal Visits

Routine prenatal visits has been followed as convention and not an evidence based benefits.

- Initial visits at early pregnancy (when a women missed her first period.
- Every 4 weeks until 28 weeks
- Every 2 weeks until 36 weeks
- Every week until delivery

Antenatal visits should cover the following

- History collection
- Examination
- Investigation

History Collection

a) Socio economic status

Low socio-economic status increases the risk of perinatal morbidity and mortality.

b) Age

Maternal age younger than 20 years increases the risk of premature births, late prenatal care, low birth weight, uterine dysfunction, fetal death, neonatal death.

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